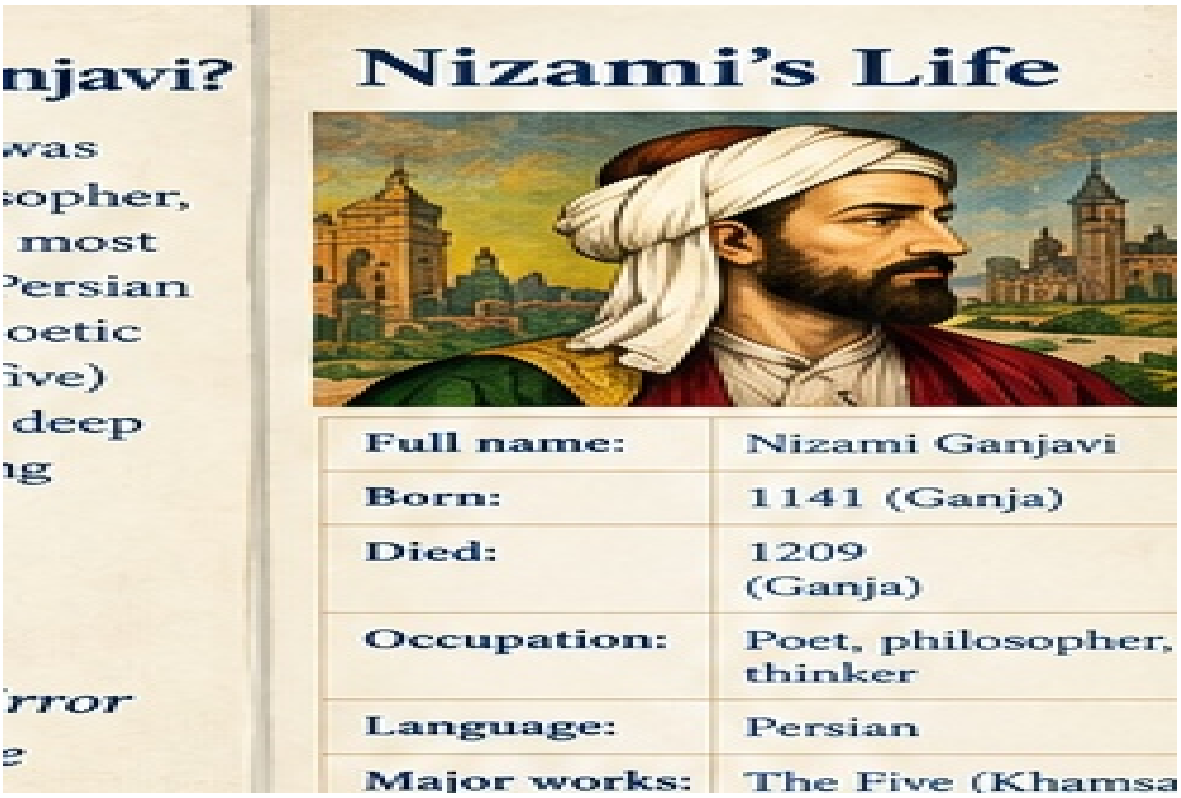
NIZAMI GANJAVI

Poet • Philosopher • Thinker

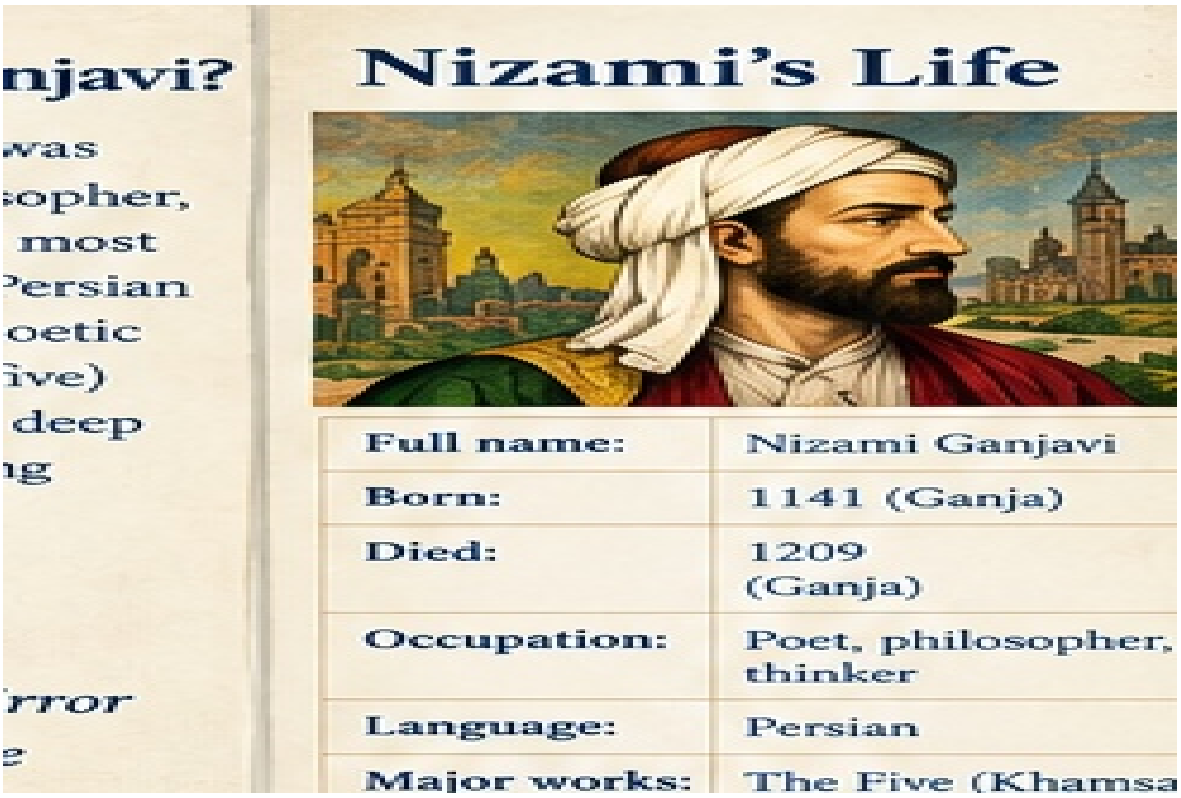


An illustrated introduction to Nizami Ganjavi, the Khamsa and the ideas behind his most famous stories.

AI-illustration note: the visuals in this edition are artistic illustrations and are not presented as authenticated historical portraits or manuscript photographs.

Who Was Nizami Ganjavi?

Nizami Ganjavi (1141–1209) was a major poet associated with Ganja. He is best known for the *Khamsa*, a cycle of five narrative poems that became central to the classical Persian literary tradition.



The Metropolitan Museum of Art identifies Nizami as from Ganja and dates his life to 1141–1209.

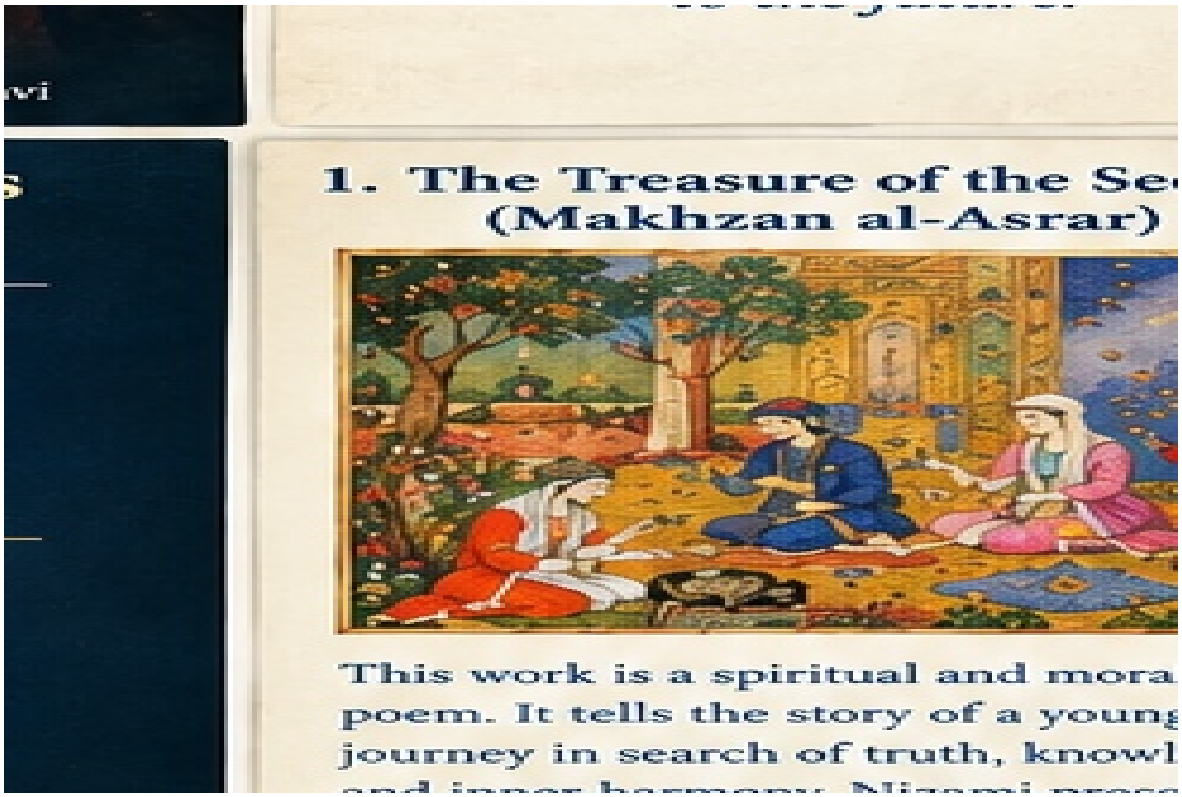
The Khamsa — Five Major Poems

1. Makhzan al-Asrar — The Treasury of Mysteries
2. Khosrow and Shirin
3. Layla and Majnun
4. Haft Paykar — The Seven Beauties
5. Iskandar-namah — The Book of Alexander

Together, these works combine narrative, ethics, philosophy, romance and reflections on leadership and human character.

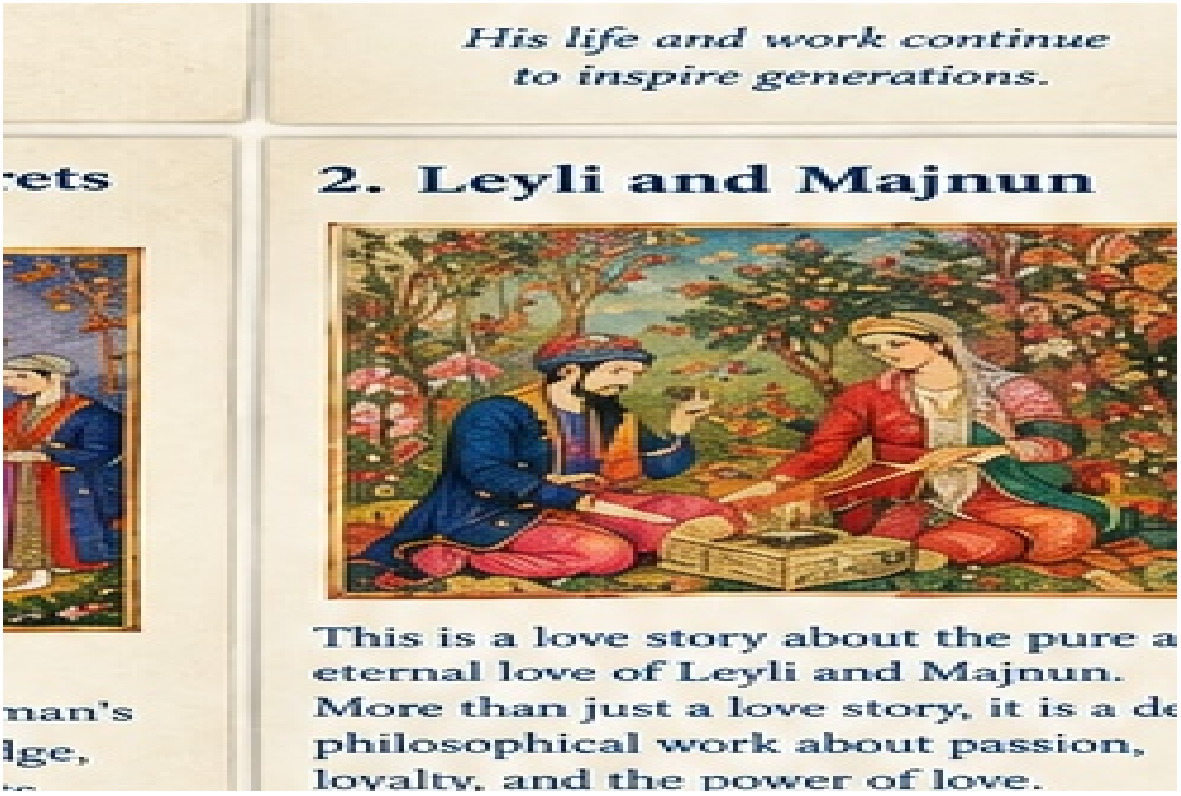
The Treasury of Mysteries

A work centered on wisdom, ethics, spirituality and the search for a meaningful life.



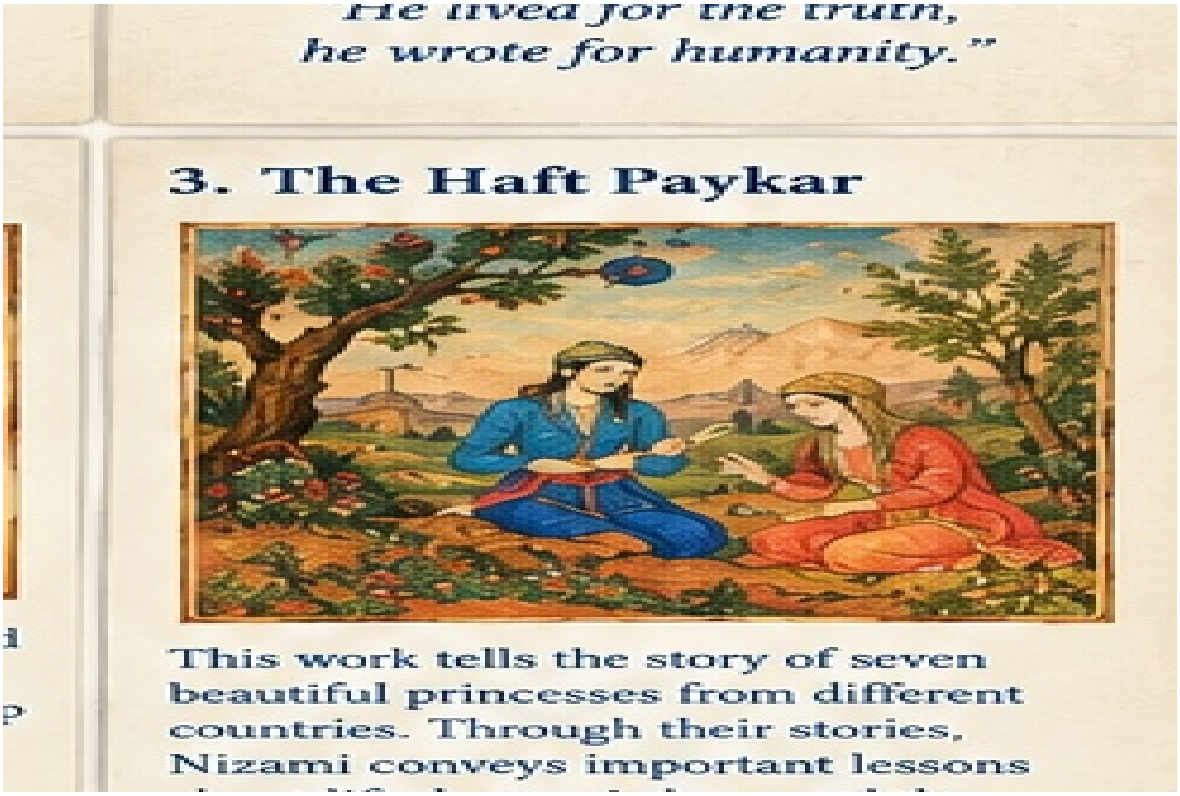
Khosrow and Shirin

A celebrated romance exploring love, loyalty, sacrifice, power and patience.



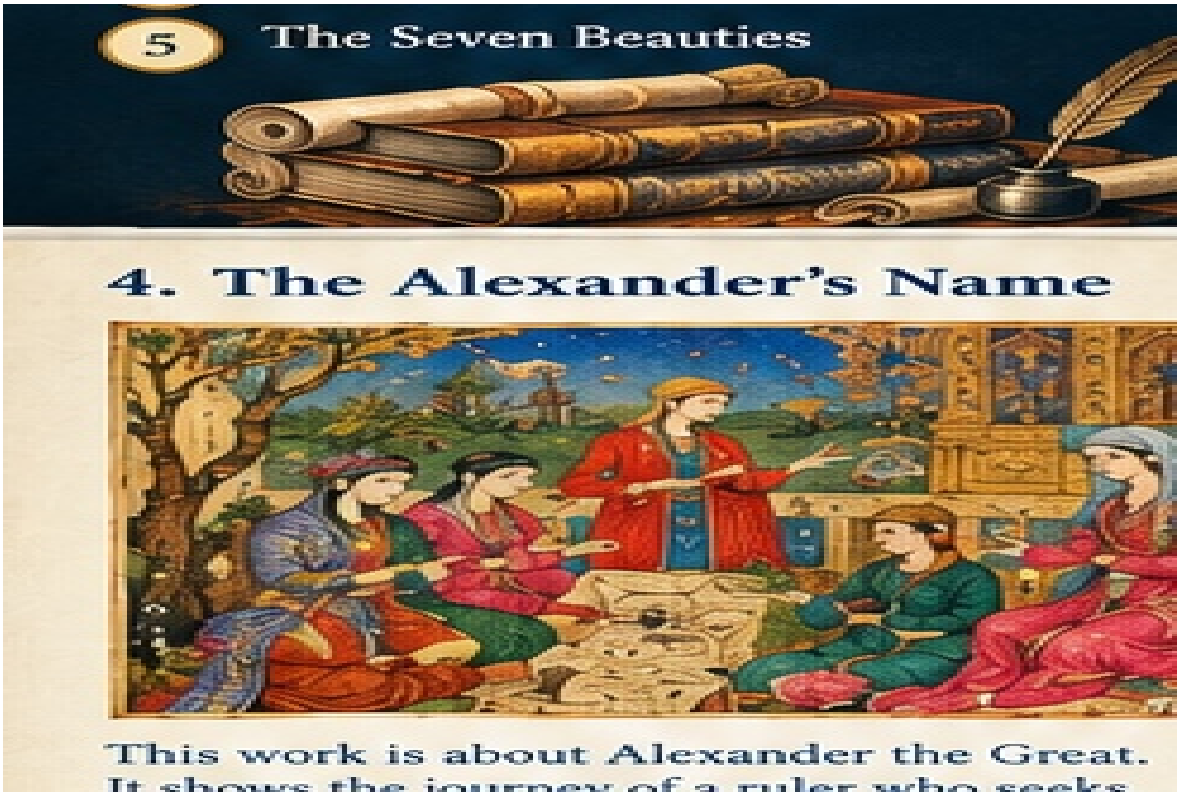
Layla and Majnun

A tragic love story about longing, separation, devotion and the tension between personal desire and social boundaries.



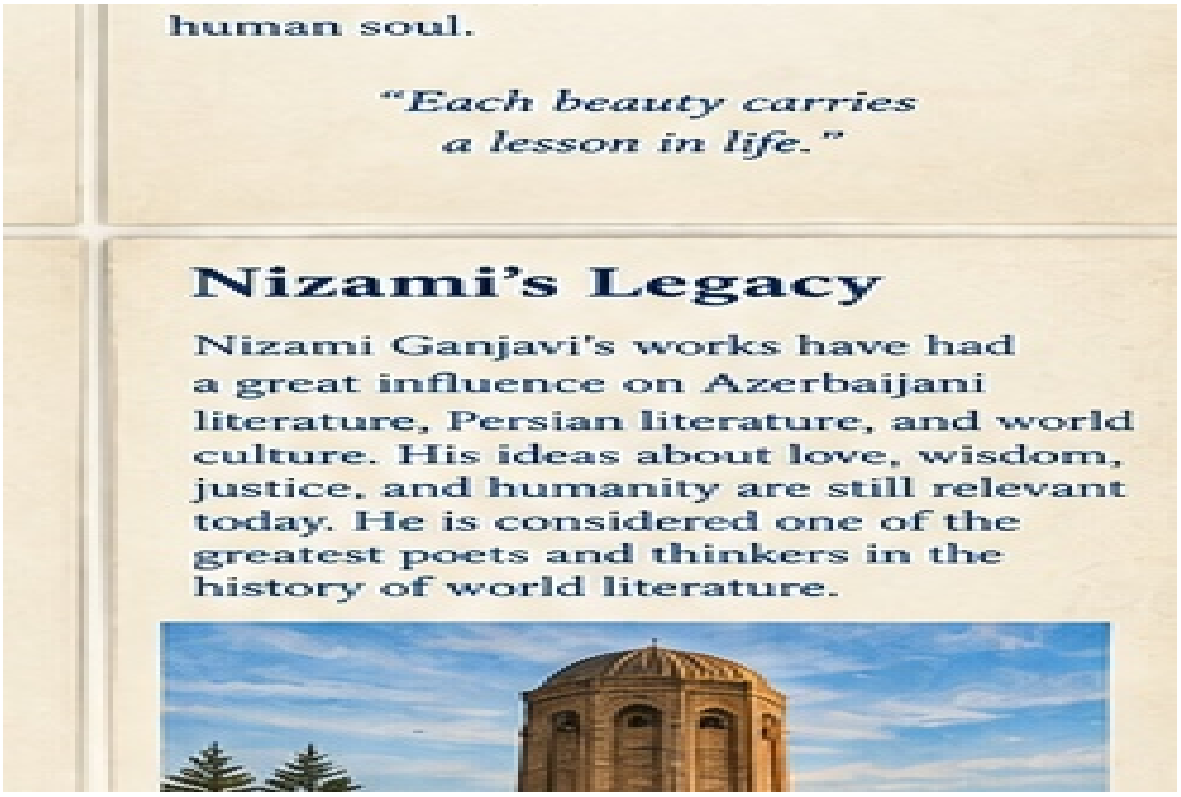
The Seven Beauties

A richly structured narrative in which stories told by seven princesses open questions about character, morality, kingship and human behaviour.



The Book of Alexander

A philosophical journey involving knowledge, leadership, justice and the search for wisdom.



POETRY SECTION

English Adaptation 1 — Wisdom

Seek knowledge not for pride,
but for the light it brings.
A wise heart weighs its own deeds
before it judges another.
The world is brief;
let your kindness outlive your name.

Original English adaptation created for this edition. This is not presented as an exact translation of Nizami's Persian text or as a quotation from a published translator.

POETRY SECTION

English Adaptation 2 — Love

Love is not merely a meeting of two hearts;
it is patience when the road grows hard.
A crown can command a kingdom,
but it cannot command affection.
True devotion is measured by sacrifice.

Original English adaptation created for this edition. This is not presented as an exact translation of Nizami's Persian text or as a quotation from a published translator.

POETRY SECTION

English Adaptation 3 — Longing

The lover carries a name in silence,
and the silence becomes his song.
Distance may separate two bodies,
yet longing can keep two souls awake.
The heart refuses to forget.

Original English adaptation created for this edition. This is not presented as an exact translation of Nizami's Persian text or as a quotation from a published translator.

POETRY SECTION

English Adaptation 4 — The Seven Stories

Every beautiful face hides a story,
and every story carries a lesson.
Wisdom wears many colours:
patience, courage, justice and mercy.
A ruler must first learn to rule himself.

Original English adaptation created for this edition. This is not presented as an exact translation of Nizami's Persian text or as a quotation from a published translator.

POETRY SECTION

English Adaptation 5 — The Traveller

A traveller may cross many kingdoms
and still remain a stranger to himself.
Power is a road, not a destination.
Knowledge remains when armies are gone.
Seek the truth beyond the crown.

Original English adaptation created for this edition. This is not presented as an exact translation of Nizami's Persian text or as a quotation from a published translator.

POETRY SECTION

English Adaptation 6 — Life

The years move like water beneath a bridge.
Gold cannot hold them;
fame cannot turn them back.
Leave behind a generous deed,
a useful word,
and a mind that searched for truth.

Original English adaptation created for this edition. This is not presented as an exact translation of Nizami's Persian text or as a quotation from a published translator.

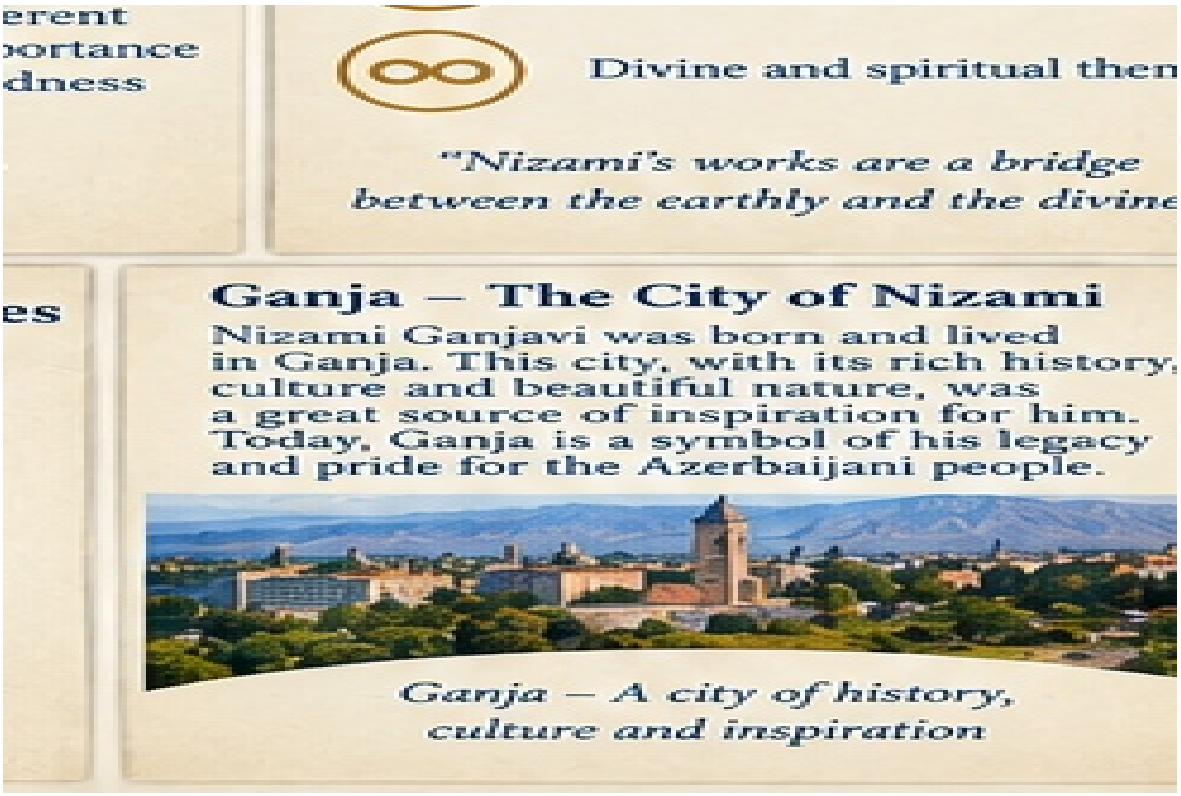
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Ganja and Nizami's Legacy



Nizami's name remains closely connected with Ganja, while his stories continue to be read, translated, illustrated and studied internationally.